



CARING CORPORATES

30% provide regular health check-ups to employees

20% serve fruit and health foods in their canteens

16% make gym facilities available to employees

18% encourage sport within the organisation

22% organise health-related talks for employees

70% companies don't have wellness facilities. Those who do have witnessed...



14%

rise in employee productivity



27%

drop in employee absenteeism



32%

hike in employee retention



82%

improvement in corporates' caring image



26%

stepdown in medicare expenses

report, "as well as more pressure from stakeholders for breakthrough results." Not just that, the shifting contours of the post-globalisation family have created new circumstances. "Urban homes are primarily nuclear, often dual income and with little support system," says Manju Mehta, head of psychology at the All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Delhi. "The changing roles create new demands and new stress."

Every day, Chandrasekaran wakes up at the crack of dawn, even if he burns the midnight oil the evening before. He gets ready, drives down to the Chennai beach for a jog. Half-an-hour later, soaked in sweat, he heads to a state-of-the-art gym to work on his body. The IT honcho recognises the pulls and pressures of his job and the need to de-stress: "I take regular vacations with my family," says this travel buff. Music is the other passion for the man, who likes to stay in Chennai during the December Margazhi festival when the city comes alive to the sound of music. "When I feel stressed, I unwind with music," he says. Not just listening, he composes his own numbers whenever he finds time.

Working hard and smart is the road ahead if you want to survive.

"The key to better performance is a healthy diet. Many companies have introduced nutrition as a part of the perks that they gift to their employees."

days. There's a growing recognition that food can enhance or bring down your performance."

What about peace of mind? The problem does not seem to stem from financial dissatisfaction. If in 1998-99, there was a 44 per cent dissatisfaction rate with perks and compensation, in 2008-09 it's less than 23 per cent. The problem is not work overload, too. Earlier 45.26 per cent employees felt overworked, which fell to 31 per cent in 2008-09. Check out the reality up close: overall stress zoomed by 11.5 per cent, work-related insecurity by 16.79 per

cent, home stress by 17.7 per cent and daily pressures by 7.8 per cent.

Are today's executives caught in, what management gurus call, "the trap of overwhelming demands"? Says Kennedy, "The current global economic meltdown has had a turbulent effect on stress quotients." The pressure to perform becomes harder when economic turbulence hits, write Ashish Singh and Mark Gottfredson of Bain & Company in a 2008 publication of the business and strategy consulting firm. "Today's CEOs are facing ever stronger economic headwinds," they

"Stress is a burst of energy," says Ambrish Mithal, endocrinologist with Apollo Hospital, Delhi. "It's our body telling us what we need to do." Eat well, do pranayam, quit smoking, find time to work out, schedule vacations with family (and remember to leave the Blackberry behind). When you travel for work, make an effort to get out and see the sights, focus consciously on happy images from the past. Remember, with more fitness and better diet you have already won half the battle. The road ahead is uphill but, at least, up.

with Shruti Chauhan, Nandini Vaish, Swagata Sen